



Matthias Florian Sahli

Postdoctoral Researcher

Bern University of Applied Sciences, Business School

Brückenstrasse 73, 3005 Bern, Switzerland

matthias.sahli@bfh.ch · sahlimatthias.com · [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=...) · [ORCID](https://orcid.org/...)

● SUMMARY

I am a postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, and was previously a researcher at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations. I received my PhD in Economics from the University of Neuchâtel in 2023. My research focuses on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization, sustainability and the creative industries. The goal of my work is to provide solid empirical evidence that supports current policy discussions. To do this, I invest considerable time and creativity in developing new datasets and conducting rigorous econometric analyses.

● ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2024 – present	Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) · Business School, Bern, Switzerland Postdoctoral Researcher
2019 – 2024	World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024)

● EDUCATION

2019 – 2023	University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland PhD in Economics
2016 – 2019	University of Bern · Bern, Switzerland MSc in Economics
2012 – 2016	University of Bern · Bern, Switzerland BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences
2006 – 2011	Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts

VISITING

2020	Copenhagen Business School (CBS) · Copenhagen, Denmark Visiting student
2020	University of Southern Denmark (SDU) · Odense, Denmark Visiting student
2017	École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL) · Lausanne, Switzerland Visiting student

● FURTHER POSITIONS

2017 – 2019	Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI) · Bern, Switzerland Internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist, Office of the Chief Economist (2018–2019)
2013 – 2019	Velokurier Bern · Bern, Switzerland Bike messenger; member of the cooperative (passive member since)
2011 – 2012	Stiftung RGZ · Zurich, Switzerland Community service, school for people with multiple disabilities

● RESEARCH

18 publications & papers	66 citations	4 h-index	5 peer-reviewed venues
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Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-08-08.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 10 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 3 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 13 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 19 citations

UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage**
R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records**
SUBMITTED TO JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC BEHAVIOR & ORGANIZATION
L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
SUBMITTED TO NPJ HERITAGE SCIENCE
M. Sahli et al. · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy**
SUBMITTED TO STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL
A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Open by Design: An Empirical Comparison of National Library Digitization Strategies on Wikimedia Commons**
IN PREPARATION
M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026

BOOK CHAPTERS, DISSERTATION & OTHER OUTPUT

- **Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights**
B Lutes, A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics ...](https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics-...), 2025 · 2025
- **Empirical Essays on the Economics of Creative Industries** **PHD DISSERTATION**
M. Sahli · *University of Neuchâtel* · 2023
- **VoxEU column: How the US film industry mitigates financial risk**
A Cuntz, A Muscarnera, PC Oguguo, M Sahli · <https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/how-us-film-industry-mitigates-financial-risk>, 2023 · 2023
- **Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects**
A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and ...](https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and-...), 2023 · 2023
- **The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany** **BOOK CHAPTER**
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *CEPR Press & Covid Economics 82* · 2022 · 17 citations
- **Pommerehne Prize, President's Prize and Young Researchers Workshop Best Paper Award**
F Etro, D Noonan · *Journal of Cultural Economics 45 (3), 513-514*, 2021 · 2021

• **VoxEU column: Appropriation artists: Follow-on innovation versus intermediary liability and trade**

A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation ...](https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation-...), 2021 · 2021

• **TEACHING**

2026 –	HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève Economics of Innovation (guest lectures)
2025 –	Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School Entrepreneurial Law (Master) · Digitalrecht (Bachelor) · Data Literacy (continuing education); lecturer and module coordination ★ Student evaluation 5.25 / 6 (6 = best possible score)
2025	EPFL, College of Management MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ Student evaluation 1.24 / 4 (1 = best possible score)
ongoing	BFH Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects

• **SELECTED TALKS**

11/2026	DINAcon — Conference for Digital Sustainability, Kongresszentrum Bern · Bern, Switzerland	SCHEDULED
11/2026	Swiss National Library · Bern, Switzerland	SCHEDULED
10/2026	DUN — Dachverband der Urheber- und Nachbarrechtsnutzer · Switzerland	SCHEDULED
06/2026	European Academy of Management Annual Conference (EURAM 2026) · Kristiansand, Norway	
06/2025	International Conference on Cultural Economics (ACEI) · Rotterdam, Netherlands (3 papers)	
06/2025	IP-Network BFH — IP and Economics · Bern, Switzerland	
04/2025	BFH sounding board meeting · Bern, Switzerland	
06/2024	DRUID24 · Nice, France	
03/2024	EPFL STIP Research Retreat · Crans-Montana, Switzerland	
02/2024	Cultural Economics Online Seminars — symposium on causal inference in cultural economics · online (video recording on YouTube)	
10/2023	Unlocking value from digital heritage collections — invited panellist (Wikimedia Italy) · Turin, Italy	
07/2023	SERCI Annual Congress · Bournemouth, UK	
03/2023	Digital Economy Workshop, University of Lausanne · Lausanne, Switzerland	
11/2022	WIPO internal research seminar · Geneva, Switzerland	
09/2022	SERCI Annual Congress, University of Colorado Law School · Boulder, USA	
09/2022	European Policy for Intellectual Property Conference (EPIP), University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK	
09/2022	Tenth European Workshop on Applied Cultural Economics · Turin, Italy (participant)	
07/2022	Urban Creativity Conference, University of Lisbon · Lisbon, Portugal	
06/2022	Munich Summer Institute (MSI) · Munich, Germany	
04/2022	Cultural Economics Online Seminar · online (video recording on YouTube)	
04/2022	WIPO internal online seminar · online	
09/2021	EPIP PhD Workshop · Madrid, Spain	
07/2021	ACEI Young Researchers Workshop, 21st Conference on Cultural Economics · Lille, France	
06/2021	IRENE PhD Meeting, University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland	
03/2021	IP & Innovation PhD Virtual Seminar, University of Lausanne · online	
12/2020	Research Workshop, Copenhagen Business School · Copenhagen, Denmark	
11/2020	PhD Seminar Series, University of Southern Denmark · Odense, Denmark	
09/2020	PhD Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (Law and Economics, Prof. S. Bechtold) · Zurich, Switzerland	
06/2020	First Econ Online Seminar, WIPO · Geneva, Switzerland	
10/2018	Reinventing the world — the power of Industry 4.0 · Belgrade, Serbia	

● OUTREACH, MEDIA COVERAGE & OTHER OUTPUT

PODCASTS

2023 [Do Market Players React to Court Decisions Impacting Art?](#) · Art Law Podcast (Spotify)

COLUMNS

2025 [Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights](#) · VoxEU Column

09/2023 [The effect of copyright on the digitisation and availability of visual artworks](#) · VoxEU / CEPR

BLOG COVERAGE

10/2023 [Life after Death: The Effects of an Artist's Death on Exhibitions and Auctions](#) · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

04/2023 [Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects](#) · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

REPORTS & NOTES

2021 [COVID-19 impact on artistic income — WIPO Economic Research Working Paper No. 65](#) · WIPO

2020 [WIPO Creative Economy Note 2020/21](#) · WIPO

● ORGANIZED CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

2025 – 2026 ICT4S 2026 International Conference, Bern University of Applied Sciences
Organizing Committee

11/2022 An Industry Practitioners Event on Intellectual Property Rights and U.S. Movie Finance, WIPO
Geneva
Co-organizer

● POLICY WORK

2018 Value of IP in the New Economy. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/648) · Co-author

2017 Intellectual Property & Innovation: Inclusive Innovation and MSME Trade. WTO TRIPS submission
(IP/C/W/635) · Co-author

● GRANTS & AWARDS

2026 Swisscom study — “From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World
Emission Reductions?” (CHF 32,409)

2021 Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural
Economics, Lille (USD 500)

2020 Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS
/ Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

● ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer review Journal of Cultural Economics (2) · European Journal of Law and Economics (1) · Humanities and
Social Sciences Communications (1) · Socio-Economic Review (1) · Economics of Governance (1)

Memberships Society for Economic Research on Copyright Issues (2022–2024) · European Policy for Intellectual
Property (2022–2024) · Association for Cultural Economics International (until 2027)

● DOCTORAL COURSES

Workshop and lecture series in law and economics — ETH Zurich and the Universities of Lucerne, St. Gallen and Zurich
(Prof. E. Ash, Prof. S. Bechtold, Prof. G. Hertig, Prof. S. Lüchinger, Prof. A. Stremitzer), Spring 2021

Obtaining data from the internet: data crawling for research in business and economics — University of Zurich (Prof. C.
Peukert, Prof. J. Claussen), Spring 2021

● RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

Interests Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied
econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization

Languages Swiss German (native) · German · English · French
Software Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling

● REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Gaétan de Rassenfosse
EPFL

Dr. Carsten Fink
Chief Economist, WIPO

E-mail addresses available on request.

Prof. Dr. Jan Bieser
Bern University of Applied Sciences

Dr. Alexander Cuntz
Senior Economist, WIPO